the news that 2 Rajput between Bridge 3 and Temporary Bridge had been overrun, as had 1/9 GR at Tsangdhar even though there were still some pockets of resistance. The 4 Grenadiers company at the Drokung Samba Bridge had also met the same fate. Thomas was also told that when last contacted, Dalvi and Brigade HQ were trying to get to Hathung-la where they hoped to take a stand.

At this stage, the conversation was interrupted by the GOC, Niranjan Prasad, who asked to speak to the CO, Lieutenant Colonel Harihar Singh. By then 9 Punjab was also patched into the line, allowing GOC 4 Division to talk to both commanding officers simultaneously. Prasad told Mishra to withdraw his battalion to Hathung-la via Bridge 1. The Grenadiers were to hold their position till 5 p.m., wait until the last Punjab platoon had gone through, then immediately follow the Punjabis to Hathung-la where Dalvi was expected to marry up with them. Oscar Thomas also succeeded in getting through to Delta Company at Serkhim and Jemadar Gian Singh at Hathung-la. He was told by both these positions that there were no Chinese troops in their vicinity at that stage.

In his book, Dalvi goes out of his way to protect his commanding officers, especially Mishra. But it is alleged that Mishra, after speaking to Prasad, did not follow orders. Mishra's first task was to get through to Tsangle, where he spoke to the Alpha Company commander, Major Khanna. The Chinese, after making some initial moves against the position, had decided to ignore Tsangle. Mishra told Khanna that the area east of him was now in Chinese control. He advised him to take Major Minuwala, the Alpha Company commander of 1/9 GR with him and get out via Bhutan. Mishra then asked if Havildar Malkiat Singh, who along with twenty men was carrying snow clothing for the post, had reached Tsangle. Khanna replied in the negative. Malkiat (who had performed heroically at Tseng Jong just ten days earlier, and his party) was never to be seen again. It can be presumed that they were ambushed and killed by the Chinese somewhere between Temporary Bridge and Tsangle.

Harihar Singh and the Grenadiers waited for 9 Punjab to show up along the track from Bridge 2, but there was no sign of the Punjabis. Unknown to them, Mishra, after advising Khanna to escape from Tsangle, had decided to do the same. He ordered the battalion to extricate itself from Bridge 2 and head straight up through the forested slopes to the heights behind them. The Chinese, who had 9 Punjab under observation, and had been sporadically